

create realistic graphics (assuming you've got the talent), and there's even a free version! Try out the Windows version of the free Personal Learning Edition on this month's DVD. We've talked about Maya in previous issues of *Digit*, and since there's not much difference between the Windows, Mac and Linux versions, there's not much more to say than "enjoy!"

8.4 Office Tools

8.4.1 Microsoft Office

The big daddy of software, Microsoft, released its first version of Office for Macintosh in 1989. Yes, one full year before the first Windows version appeared! Office 2004 is, naturally, paid software, and you'll need to shell out \$399 (Rs 16,000) for the standard edition. The current version is Office 2004 and the new version, Office 2008, will ship later this year.

Office is one of the few applications by Microsoft that really stands out in terms of usability and features. Office 2004 for Mac offers all the features and programs that Office 2003 offered for Windows, with the exception of Microsoft Access.

One of the negative points about Microsoft Office 2004 is that it is not a universal binary—that is, it is not an Intel-native application yet. It has to be run on Intel Macs under Rosetta, a PPC emulation mode. For home users, this does not pose much of a problem, but for professionals, who are Microsoft's target market, running



The standard Word interface

Office under Rosetta is not a pleasant experience, especially when dealing with large files. Office 2008 will be a universal binary.

The interface of Office 2004 is innovative and elegant. Unlike